



# GOLF HANDBOOK



**Sun City Hilton Head**  
COMMUNITY ASSOCIATION

TROON GOLF®

# GOLF HANDBOOK

Sun City Hilton Head offers a wide range of golf and fellowship opportunities for residents who play occasionally as well as those who wish to play every day. In addition to individual tee times, which can be booked online, there are a number of golf associations for men, women, couples, and 9- and 18-hole players. Review the Chartered Club listings in *SunSations* for more information.

Resident golf plans are available to fit a variety of needs, and a United States Golf Association (USGA) handicap can be established through the SCHH Golf Club. You will be able to post scores to update your handicap online.

This handbook provides general information and guidance for resident and guest use of the Sun City Hilton Head golf facilities. Course policies and golfer responsibilities are addressed under individual topic headings.

Golfers must abide by the Golf Course General Rules and Proper Golf Etiquette as defined in the Schedule of Fees and Community Rules. Failure to comply may result in fines and loss of golf privileges. The Community Association shall apply and enforce the Community Rules with members and residents equally.

These policies and rules have been reviewed and approved by the Community Association Board of Directors. Any questions regarding these topics should be directed to the Head Golf Professionals or to golf course staff.

Playing golf is a rich part of the Sun City Hilton Head lifestyle. One only has to become involved in one or more of the activities to begin a lifetime of enjoyment.



SUN CITY HILTON HEAD COMMUNITY ASSOCIATION, INC.



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Cover photo by Crescent Moon Productions.



## I. RESERVATION/TEE TIME PROCEDURES

A resident tee time may be reserved via the online reservation system (Chelsea) at <http://hilthead.chelseareservations.com> or by calling the golf shop up to three days in advance. New residents must visit one of the golf shops to create a Chelsea account. *Note: Chelsea reservation details are available in each golf shop.*

## II. REGISTRATION AND CHECK-IN

All golfers and their guests must check in with the golf shop prior to commencing play. Golfers are encouraged to arrive and check in with the bag drop or golf shop staff prior to their scheduled tee time. However, golfers must check in at least 15 minutes prior to their scheduled tee time to avoid possible loss of tee time and/or a cancellation charge.

## III. CANCELLATIONS

Reserved tee times may be cancelled by emailing or calling the golf shop at least two hours prior to the scheduled tee time or logging into Chelsea reservation system up until 6 a.m. on the day of play. Golfers who do not check in or cancel a reservation are subject to a no-show fee.

Please note that it is each golfer's responsibility to cancel his/her own tee time. Relying on another person to cancel for you puts you at risk of penalty. The no-show fee applies to 9-hole or 18-hole reservations at any course; golf plan or green fee amounts will not be a factor. The golf shops will keep the Chelsea tee times live until 6 a.m. on the day of play. This change enables a golfer to log into Chelsea to cancel or add his/her tee time reservation overnight. The golf shops will continue to accept tee time cancellations by phone and email. **However, it is preferred to cancel via Chelsea or email** because these methods provide timestamps, which is important for early morning tee time cancellations.

The same rules apply to guests of residents, and the no-show fee will be charged to the host resident's CAM account. On days where the courses close due to unplayable conditions, the cancellation/no-show policy will be waived. On full cart path only days, golfers should still notify the golf shop of their cancellation, however, the fee for not doing so is waived.



#### IV. REFUNDS

If rain, lightning or high winds threaten play, or if a player is physically unable to continue, a refund will be issued to the golfer in accordance with the following schedule:

- **Complete holes 1-4:** 18-hole refund.
- **Complete holes 5-9:** 9-hole fee is applied.
- **Complete holes 10-14:** 9-hole fee is applied.
- **Complete holes 15-18:** 18-hole fee is applied.

#### V. DRESS CODE

Sun City Hilton Head golf courses maintain and enforce dress standards consistent with quality golf courses in the area. All residents and guests (including juniors) must conform to the dress standards stated below at all times. Residents and guests not conforming to dress code standards will be asked to make the necessary changes before playing or using practice facilities.

**Gentlemen/Boys:** Collared shirts or turtlenecks, Bermuda/golf shorts or slacks.

**Ladies/Girls:** Collared shirts, sleeveless blouses with or without collar, Bermuda/golf shorts of reasonable length, crop pants and/or slacks.

**Shoes:** Golf shoes with soft spikes (including golf sandals) or athletic shoes are required. *Metal spikes are not allowed on any Sun City golf courses.*

**Prohibited:** Denim and yoga apparel, gym shorts, sweat pants, tank tops, swim suits and related attire are not acceptable on the golf courses or practice areas.

#### VI. GOLF ETIQUETTE

Playing golf at Sun City Hilton Head is intended to be a pleasant pastime for all participants. Please see the Community Rules for further details.

##### Warm Up

Arrive early enough to allow time to warm up properly.

##### Avoid Slow Play

Pace of Play is an important issue. It impacts the capacity of a golf course to optimize the rounds played and generally ensure the best possible golf experience for the golfing public.



### **Pace of play for each course is as follows:**

- Okatie Creek – 4 hours and 5 minutes
- Hidden Cypress – 4 hours and 15 minutes
- Argent Lakes – 3 hours and 53 minutes

### **To maintain the times to play each course, the golf staff encourages the following guide for pace of play:**

- Tee it forward.
- Play ready golf.
- Keep visual contact with the group in front of you.
- Walk at a reasonable speed between shots.
- Forget honors entirely; play ready golf at all times.
- Try this guideline: From the time you pick up your coin, you have 15 seconds to putt.
- Continuous putting is highly recommended.
- Begin planning your next shot as you approach the ball by studying the strength and direction of the wind.
- When you reach your ball, check the lie, select your club, visualize your swing and shot, and then play your shot.
- It should take no more than 30-45 seconds from the time you select your club until you actually hit your shot.
- If you are not ready to play when it is your turn, encourage one of your fellow players to take their shot.
- Mark your scorecard at the next tee, not beside the green.
- Never park a golf cart on the front side of the green.
- After hitting a shot, keep your club in your hand. Replace it in the bag only after the cart has stopped at its next position.

Photo by Tom Hanley.

**Failure to maintain your position on the course in relation to other groups may require golf staff to request your group to move ahead.**

**In accordance with the Rules of Golf, golf shots may not be played from an out-of-bounds position defined by white stakes. Also, as a courtesy to our neighbors, please do not hit out of a homeowner's yard that is not defined by a white stake.**

**Please see the Community Rules for details specific to retrieval of an out-of-bounds golf ball.**

### **Maintain the Course**

Practice the three "R's" (Repair, Replace and Rake)

- Repair ball marks on greens.
- Replace your divots. On tee boxes, use sand provided, and in fairways, replace divot or use sand.
- Rake traps or bunkers. Enter traps wherever possible from the low side of the bunker. After taking your shot, rake your footsteps and any others within reach and leave rakes inside the bunker.
- Be alert for wet conditions and avoid driving into or over them.
- Observe all signage on the course or around the clubhouse.
- Smoking is prohibited in all clubhouses and on all practice facilities.
- Please do not throw your cigarette, cigar butts or seed shells on the course.

## **VII. GOLF COURSE SAFETY**

Golfers are encouraged to utilize good judgment and common sense during play. Particular caution should be exercised (but not limited to) the following conditions:

- **Excessive speeding:** Many of the golf carts owned by residents are capable of operating speeds far in excess of what is safe on the course. Golfers are required to maintain speeds of 12 mph or less in all course areas, around clubhouses and bag drop areas.
- **Threatening weather:** The Lowcountry is subject to sudden and violent weather conditions. It is the responsibility of individual golfers to remain alert to changing weather conditions and exit the course or seek shelter in the event of threatening weather. Lightning, violent wind, hail and similar events are considered threatening weather. **Note: Sun City Hilton**

***Head Community Association, Inc. does not maintain or operate any type of warning alarm or siren.***

- **Danger from wildlife:** Sun City Hilton Head golf courses are home to a wide range of wildlife including alligators, snakes, foxes, armadillo, squirrels and raccoons. Golfers must exercise caution around native wildlife. Never feed, approach or attempt to pet wildlife. Use particular caution when approaching lagoons where alligators may be present. Do not, under any circumstances, enter the water or high brush around lagoons. Use caution when entering wooded areas to retrieve a ball. In accordance with USGA rules, you are entitled to Free Relief if you are confronted with one of these situations.
- **Comfort Stations:** Restrooms, ice and water machines as well as Automated External Defibrillators (AEDs) are located throughout the golf courses at the following:
  - Hidden Cypress between holes 3 and 4 and 13 and 14
  - Okatie Creek between holes 5 and 6 and 13 and 14
  - Argent Lakes between hole 5 and 6 and 12 and 13

## **VIII. GOLF CART USAGE POLICY**

Golfers are encouraged to utilize good judgement and common sense during play. Please pay close attention to the golf cart driving rules when using the golf courses.

### **Rules for Regular Play Carts**

- Carts must follow the daily golf cart rules for cart path only, directional signage near greens, and ropes blocking areas under maintenance.
- Carts must not be driven inside directional signs and must exit the fairway and return to the cart path with the exception of registered blue flag carts.
- Carts should not be driven along steep slopes, near bunkers, or slopes to lakes.
- For the safety of others, golfers are required to maintain no more than 12 mph around the clubhouse areas.

Blue flag players will be required to apply for blue flag privileges. Bring your state-issued handicap identification information (i.e. automobile placard or driver's license indicating handicap parking privileges) to the Hidden Cypress





Golf Pro Shop. If you own a blue flag, please bring it with you as well. The Golf Pro Shop will place a button on your flag to identify it as an approved blue flag cart. You will be asked to read and sign a document agreeing to the rules for blue flag carts.

### **Rules for Blue Flag Carts**

- On a cart path only course or hole, blue flag cart privileges or Solorider carts will not be available on the course that day or at that particular hole.
- Blue flag carts may drive up to teeing areas no closer than 20 feet but may not drive on tee boxes.
- Blue flag cart privileges are extended only to the individual player needing the accommodation and not the additional rider.
- Blue flag carts may drive on the fairway of a par-3 hole but must park at a blue and white post.

To clearly identify areas where blue flag golf carts may park, blue posts with white tops are placed in a location at each green to identify the **required** blue flag golf cart parking areas, typically at the front of the green complex. You may only park the cart at the post and then exit to the cart path following the direction of the cart directional signs. **Driving on the turf around a green to get to the cart path is not allowed.**

- Solorider golf carts may be used to get closer than the blue and white posts and may be driven onto the teeing ground and putting areas. Please inquire at the Hidden Cypress Golf Pro Shop for more information.

**After receiving two verbal warnings per round of golf, failure to comply with the Golf Cart Usage Policy will result in a fine. See the Schedule of Fees and Community Rules.**

Photo by Rich de Asla

## IX. ACCOMMODATION OF DISABILITIES

Golfers with qualifying disabilities that limit their ability to walk from their golf cart to the teeing ground and putting areas may obtain a Blue Handicap Flag at the time of check-in from the bag drop staff. Presentation of a state issued ID card or valid automobile handicap placard to verify the need for an accommodation must be made in the golf shop. The blue flag, prominently displayed while driving, allows the golf cart to be driven closer (but not onto) the teeing areas, bunkers and putting surfaces. The golf staff have placed a blue and white pole at each green, this is the REQUIRED parking spot for the Blue Flag carts. No other areas around the greens may be used and carts are asked to return to the nearest cart path when exiting. These posts will be moved periodically to ensure quality turf conditions. **Failure to abide by the Blue Flag cart operating guidelines will lead to further action by the golf staff and a fine. See the Schedule of Fees and Community Rules for more information.**

For golfers with exceptional disabilities, a Solorider golf cart or other approved cart of similar design and specifications may be used closer than the blue and white pole and may be driven onto the teeing ground and putting areas. The daily use Blue Flag must be returned to the bag drop staff upon completion of play. Blue Flag and Solorider cart privileges are not allowed on cart path only days or holes. Private Blue Flags are allowed but must be registered with the golf shop at the beginning of each year and a valid state issued ID or automobile handicap placard must be presented to verify the need for an accommodation.

## X. PRACTICE FACILITIES

Range balls and baskets are the property of the facility and may not be removed from the practice areas for any reason.

Range plans are not transferable and plan holders may not share balls.

All practice facilities, driving ranges, putting greens and short game areas are non-smoking at all times.

Golf instruction on the practice facilities is limited to Sun City Hilton Head golf staff only. See the Community Rules for further details.



## **XI. GOLF COURSE STAFF AUTHORITY & RESPONSIBILITY**

Sun City Hilton Head golf course staff are empowered and required to monitor and ensure that all golfers and guests are in compliance with the standards noted in the Golf Handbook and the Community Rules. Staff members can inform and assist golfers and guests to ensure that compliance. The ultimate cooperation and responsibility, however, resides with golfers and guests.

Golfers and guests who cannot or will not comply with instructions from staff will be denied access to the course or removed if already in play.

**Questions and disputes regarding enforcement of standards should be referred to the head professional at each golf course.**

## **XII. HELPFUL INFORMATION**

### **Online reservations**

(Chelsea reservation system)

**<http://hilthead.chelseareservations.com>**

For Couples, Women's, and Men's Golf Association reservations:

**<https://www.golfgenius.com>**

### **Handicap Reporting**

Visit **<http://www.ghin.com/>**.

### **Electronic Newsletters**

**City Golf:** This electronic newsletter is distributed monthly by the Sun City Hilton Head Community Association, Inc. to the Sun City Hilton Head golfing community. You must be an eNews Weekly subscriber to receive City Golf. To subscribe to City Golf, follow the instructions below:

#### **If you are an eNews Weekly subscriber:**

- Scroll to the bottom of any eNews Weekly email and click Update Profile.
- Then select the City Golf box.

#### **If you are not an eNews Weekly subscriber:**

- Log into **[www.SunCityHiltonHead.org](http://www.SunCityHiltonHead.org)**.
- Scroll to the Account Management tile and click Opt-In eNewsletters.
- Fill out the electronic form.



- Under Additional eNewsletters, be sure to select City Golf.
- Click Subscribe at the bottom of the form.

**SCHH Golf Club Newsletter:** As a member of the SCHH Golf Club, you will receive an electronic newsletter with SCHH Golf Club information.

**SCHH Golf Website:** For golf news, an events calendar, course descriptions and more, visit **[www.golfinsuncity.com](http://www.golfinsuncity.com)**.

### **XIII. SUN CITY HILTON HEAD COMMUNITY ASSOCIATION, INC. GOLF-RELATED CHARTERED CLUBS**

**Chartered Clubs:** There are a number of Chartered Clubs related to golf in Sun City Hilton Head. Chartered Clubs are organizations sponsored by the Sun City Hilton Head Community Association, Inc. to foster and promote opportunities for all residents to pursue common interests in hobby, recreational and cultural endeavors.

The Sun City Hilton Head Community Association, Inc. Board of Directors has the sole authority to approve Chartered Clubs.

Chartered Clubs are listed in the Chartered Club News section of *SunSations*. Information is also available at club webpages accessible through the community website at **[www.SunCityHiltonHead.org](http://www.SunCityHiltonHead.org)**. To find the webpages:

- Log into **[www.SunCityHiltonHead.org](http://www.SunCityHiltonHead.org)**.
- Scroll to the Clubs & Groups tile and click Learn More.
- Scroll to the Sports tile and click Learn more.
- All current golf-related clubs are listed on this webpage. Click on any club for more information.

#### **Golf Chartered Club Membership**

Residents must join the SCHH Golf Club, a Chartered Club, to become a GHIN member before joining any other golf clubs.

To join one of the other golf clubs, pick up a membership form located at any Sun City Hilton Head golf shop. Forms are also available on the individual club webpages at **[www.SunCityHiltonHead.org](http://www.SunCityHiltonHead.org)**. Upon completion of the form, drop it off at the appropriate location. Then, sign up for a USGA Handicap



at the Okatie Creek Golf Shop. You must also register in the SCHHCA Golf Genius Tournament Management System™.

**Please note:** Some Chartered Clubs require a minimal amount of posted scores in the USGA Handicap system prior to being able to sign up and play in a club event. Please check with the specific club for more information.

### **Club Sign-ups, Deadlines and Tee Time Distribution**

Members of golf-related Chartered Clubs have the luxury of signing up for events from their home computers or in any Sun City Hilton Head golf shop. Please see the golf shops for sign-up instructions.

### **Deadline for Sign-Ups for Weekly Golf Chartered Club Events:**

- Women's Golf Association – Noon Sunday prior to play
- Men's Golf Association – Noon Monday prior to play
- Couples Golf (9-hole) – Noon Monday prior to play
- Couples Golf (18-hole) – Noon Wednesday prior to play
- Women's 9 Hole Golf Club/Men's Competition/Men's Non-Competition – Noon Thursday prior to play (effective 3/1/18)
- Golf staff is unable to take phone entries.

Tee times will be sent to all club members later that day and will be posted at all golf shop event boards.

### **General Information**

- The pairings are made through Golf Genius and the participating golfers.
- Players must sign up through Golf Genius; no phone entries are accepted.
- Golf Genius creates the pairings based on the Chartered Club guidelines; no pairing requests can be made.
- Golf Genius assigns the tee times; no tee time requests can be made.
- After pairings have been made, players do not have the ability to change their tee time for any reason.

Photo by Crescent Moon Productions.



- Once tee times or pairings are distributed, players may call the appropriate golf shop to be added to an open slot or put on the waitlist

#### **XIV. FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS**

**My 12-year-old grandson likes to play golf when me when he visits. Is it acceptable for him to drive the golf cart while on the course?**

No. Only licensed drivers are allowed to operate golf carts within Sun City, including on golf courses. Please see the Community Rules for additional details.

**How many individuals may occupy a golf cart while on the course?**

Only two individuals are allowed to occupy a cart while on the course. This is for the safety of passengers traveling on uneven surfaces.

**What is the Golf Advisory Committee?**

The Golf Advisory Committee is a Board Appointed Committee made up of resident volunteers who provide evaluation, assistance and recommendations to the Board of Directors as necessary on all matters relating to golf.

**How do I establish a handicap?**

Membership may be obtained by joining the SCHH Golf Club.  
Visit [www.schhgolfclub.com/membership](http://www.schhgolfclub.com/membership) for more information.

**Can I walk on the golf course at any time when not playing golf?**

This is strictly prohibited by the Community Rules and Governing Documents.

**Are there discounted rates for residents?**

Yes, there are several plans available that one may select from to fit your needs.  
Visit any golf shop for more details.

Photo by Rich de Asla.



**How do I make a tee time?**

You may request a tee time by accessing the Chelsea tee time online reservation system up to 11 days in advance. The system will notify you with the actual tee time given three days in advance. Inside of three days, a resident may reserve a tee time through Chelsea or over the phone for the desired course of play.

**I am new to Sun City Hilton Head. How do I get into the “swing of things?”**

Sun City Hilton Head has several organizations for men, women, couples, and 9- and 18-hole play. Ask a golf shop staff member about these clubs or see the Chartered Club News section of *SunSations*.

**Can I get golf instruction at our courses?**

Group clinics as well as individual instruction are available at each golf course.

**The ranger keeps telling me I need to speed up. I want to play at my own pace.**

Keep in mind that one slow group delays every foursome behind them and reduces their enjoyment of the game. Golf staff routinely monitors pace for the enjoyment of all players and may ask you to skip a hole to place you in to the correct position on the course.

**Can I walk the course when playing golf?**

Walking on the courses is allowed, however, in order to maintain pace of play, others have found walking is not practical due to the length between greens and tees.

**I just moved into our neighborhood and want to start a new golf group. How do I get this started?**

Talk with the golf professional staff.

**XV. QUESTIONS, COMMENTS AND SUGGESTIONS**

Input or inquiries for improving golf at Sun City Hilton Head can be referred to the head golf professional at each course or the Golf Advisory Committee (GAC).



**Sun City Hilton Head**  
COMMUNITY ASSOCIATION

TRON GOLF®

**SUN CITY HILTON HEAD COMMUNITY  
ASSOCIATION, INC. COMMUNITY WEBSITE**  
**[www.SunCityHiltonHead.org](http://www.SunCityHiltonHead.org)**

**SUN CITY HILTON HEAD GOLF CLUB**  
**[www.schhgolfclub.com](http://www.schhgolfclub.com)**

**ONLINE RESERVATIONS**  
**<http://hilthead.chelseareservations.com>**

**HANDICAP REPORTING**  
**<http://www.ghin.com/>**

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**SUN CITY HILTON HEAD COMMUNITY ASSOCIATION, INC.**